CHRONO EXPRESS

Beta readiness audit | Team handover | 13 October 2026

Overall verdict: Not yet verified as beta-demonstration-ready. The codebase has three levels, a successful production build, and passing automated tests; however, the trailer, credits and end-to-end gameplay verification need urgent attention.

Evidence basis: Wits COMS3006A/COMS3025A CGV Project Brief (15 pages), plus the Cursor audit summary supplied by the team on 13 October 2026. This document is a concise handover, not an independent source-code review. The detailed Cursor report was not supplied in full.

1. Verified checks and limitations

- Production build: PASS - npm run build; Vite base reported as ./. Large-chunk warning remains.
- Automated tests: PASS - 29/29 tests.
- No repository modifications were made during the audit.
- Not verified: actual browser playthrough, runtime FPS/memory, published LAMP deployment, trailer submission and in-person demo.

2. Rubric coverage

Category	Weight	Audit status	Evidence / main gap
Viewing	10%	Partial	Cameras and animation present; camera comfort and finale unverified
Control & Playability	10%	Partial	Controls/checkpoints present; lives can reach zero without game over
3D Effects	15%	Partial	Lights, textures, sky and bump effects; reflection/IBL polish limited
Shaders	10%	Complete in code	Five custom shaders and uniforms reported; live demonstration still needed
Gameplay & Experience	25%	Partial	Three distinct levels; balance, full progression and finale need playtest
Polish	10%	Partial	Menus/HUD/restart present; credits contain placeholders
Innovation	10%	Partial	Time Ghost, Level 3 hazards and shaders; demonstrate clearly
Game Trailer	10%	Missing / unverified	No trailer or URL found in repository; check team submission externally

3. Highest-priority work before beta

CRITICAL - Trailer: Record/edit a trailer no longer than 2 minutes, upload to YouTube, confirm submission instructions and link. Absence from repo does not prove nobody has made it.

CRITICAL - Credits: Replace team placeholder(s) in src/ui/credits.js; identify and credit third-party libraries, textures, models, audio and adapted resources, including cracked-stone.png and train-tracks.jpg if externally sourced.

CRITICAL - Full playthrough: Manually verify New Game -> Level 1 -> Level 2 -> Level 3 -> Complete, including transitions, checkpoints, time powers, deaths and victory credits.

HIGH - Time ability exports: Audit reports triggerSlow / triggerFreeze / triggerRewind exports in time-system.js (~596-598) call setMode directly and may bypass SFX. Verify call sites and fix only if real.

HIGH - Game-over logic: Audit reports a commented-out game-over handler in main.js (~265-276); investigate zero-lives behavior and respawn semantics before enabling it.

HIGH - Binding-aware tutorials: Some Level 2/3 toasts reportedly hard-code [1]/Q or Shift. Replace with configured binding labels where appropriate.

HIGH - Unlisted H4: Cursor verdict references H1-H4, but the pasted summary describes only H1-H3. Retrieve H4 from the full audit before finalizing the task list.

4. Team action checklist

[ ] Assign owners for trailer, credits, gameplay fixes, playtesting and demonstration.

[ ] Verify the trailer exists and is <= 2 minutes; confirm upload/link.

[ ] Complete and review third-party credits, including source and licence where applicable.

[ ] Run a complete browser playthrough from New Game without developer shortcuts.

[ ] Confirm zero-lives behavior, time-ability SFX, and dynamic keybinding hints.

[ ] Confirm every team member can explain the custom shaders and distinctive mechanics of each level.

[ ] Build and serve dist/ over HTTP; check console for 404s and runtime errors.

[ ] Test relative paths, exact asset filename case, and the deployment subdirectory.

[ ] Check performance on modest/lab hardware and memory over a three-level run.

[ ] Confirm beta-specific Moodle instructions, venue, deadline and any required upload.

5. Suggested 48-hour schedule

- 13 Oct: Assign tasks, inspect high-priority bugs, perform first full playthrough and list blockers.
- 14 Oct: Fix blockers, finish credits and trailer, run production-build playthrough, rehearse explanations.
- 15 Oct (beta): Smoke-test the exact demonstration version, verify external links and present.

6. Rubric notes and scope

The beta is graded. Minor bugs and even an incomplete level or two may be acceptable, but the project should be fundamentally finished and nearly production-ready. The trailer is required at beta; the devlog is required only for final submission. The brief requires three genuinely different levels, keyboard and mouse controls, meaningful custom shaders, proper credits and eventual static LAMP deployment. The exact Moodle dates and submission instructions take precedence.

Source: Wits CGV Project Brief, sections 3-6, 8.2, 11-12 (especially pp. 3, 5-9, 11, 13-15); Cursor beta audit summary provided by the team on 13 Oct 2026.